

Agents

LLMs, Agents, Environments

How LLMs and Agents are post-trained.

EECS 189/289, Spring 2026 @ UC Berkeley

Roadmap

- What is an agent
- What is an Environment (Terminal Bench)
- How are agents Evaluated, Trained and Optimized
- <https://course-evaluations.berkeley.edu/>

Q1: What is an agent?

- First what is an LLM. An LLM is a box that takes tokens and produces tokens.

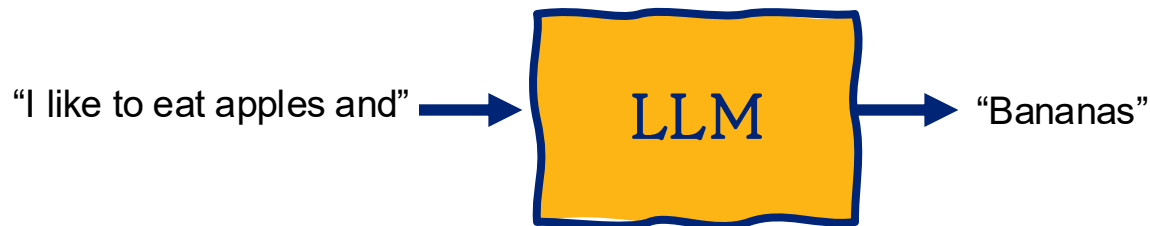
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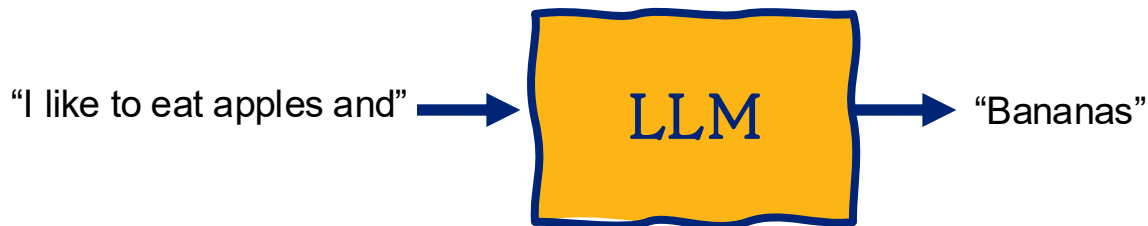
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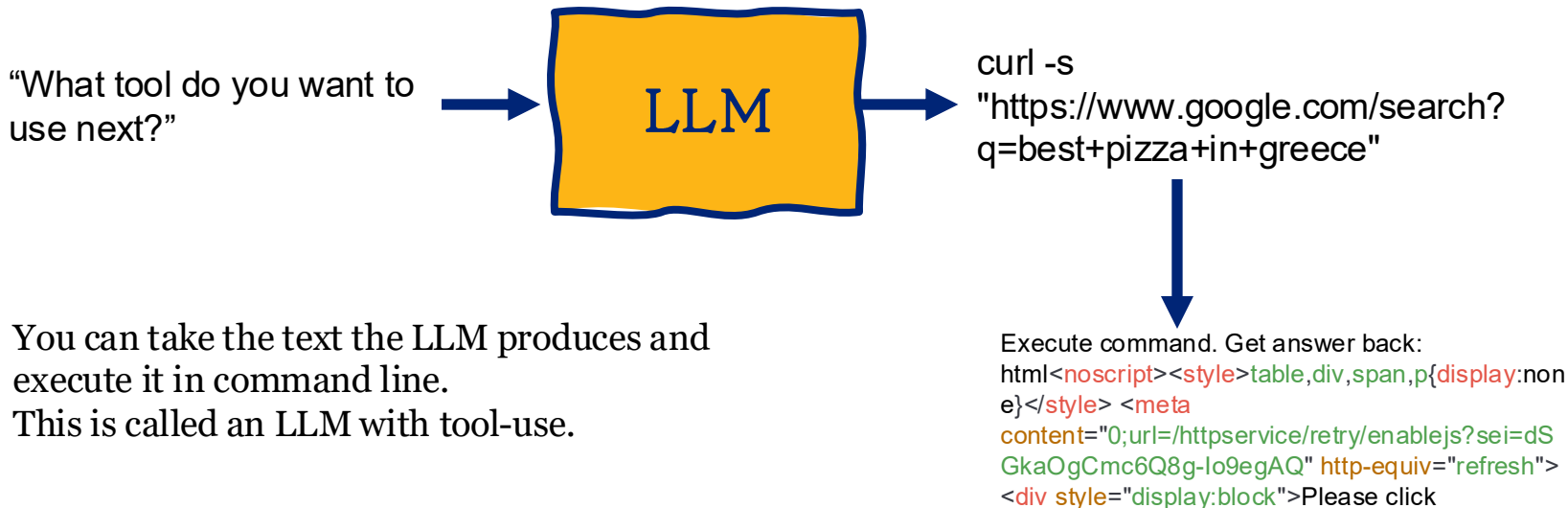
- First what is an LLM. An LLM is a box that takes tokens and produces tokens.



- An LLM cannot do a Google search. It cannot read a document, or email.
- To perform inference with an LLM you run it VLLM, Ollama, or call it by API.

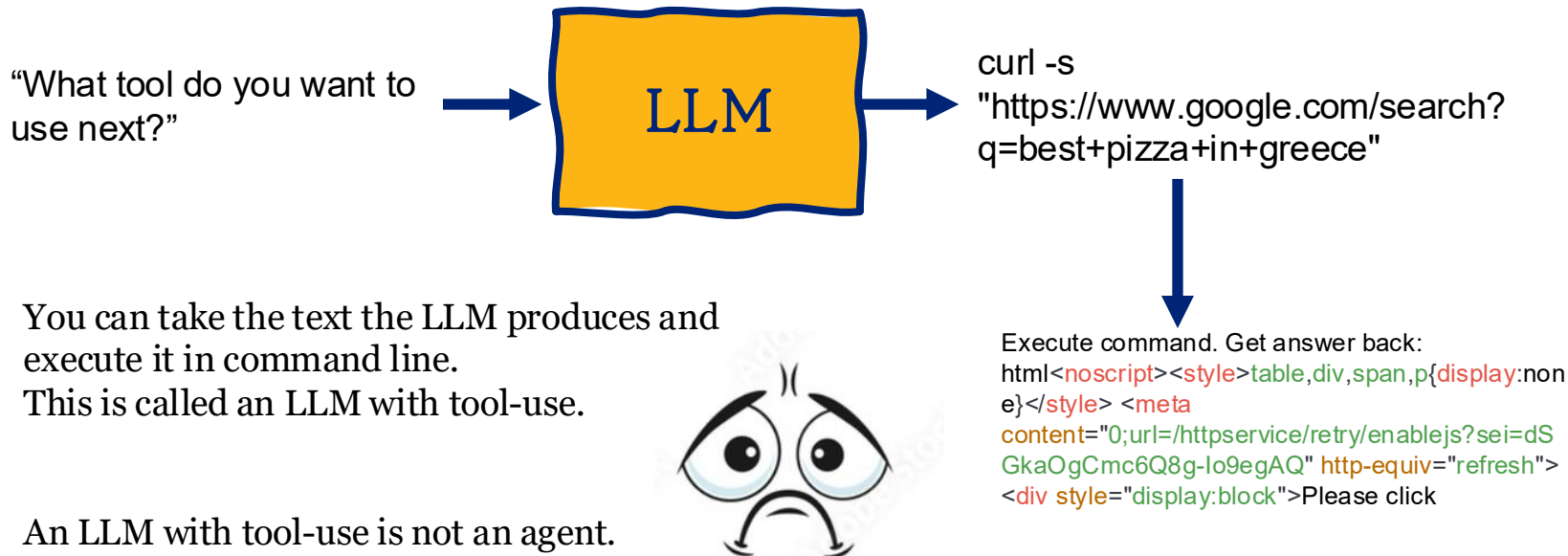
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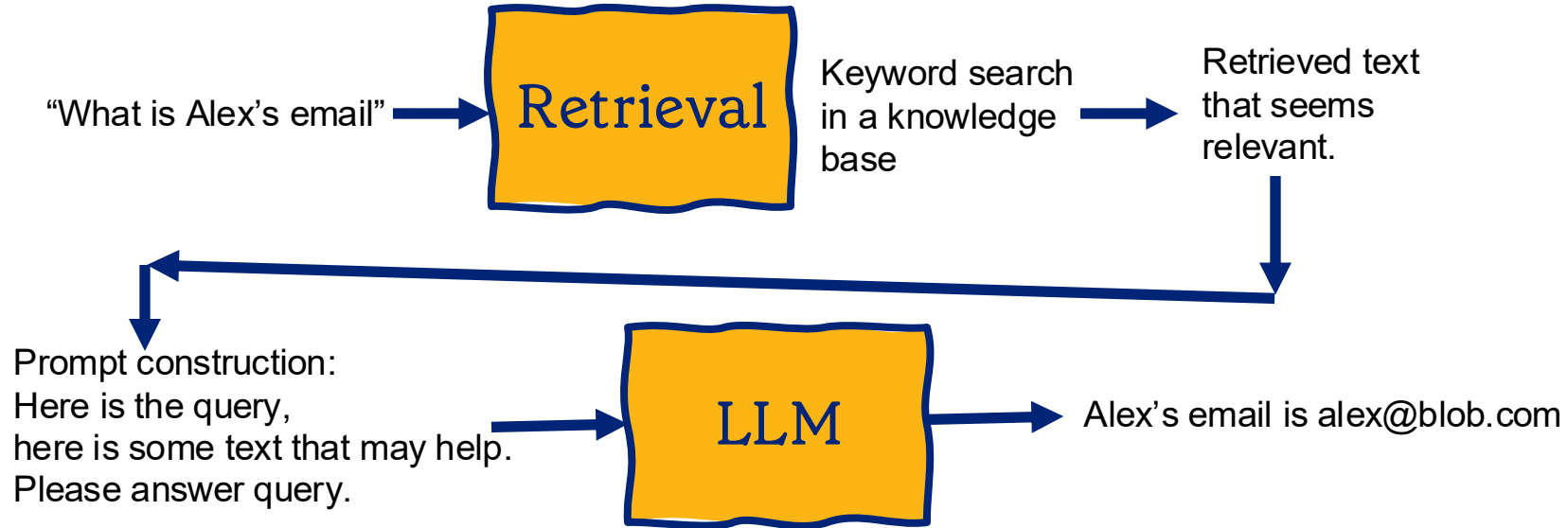


Q1: What is an agent?

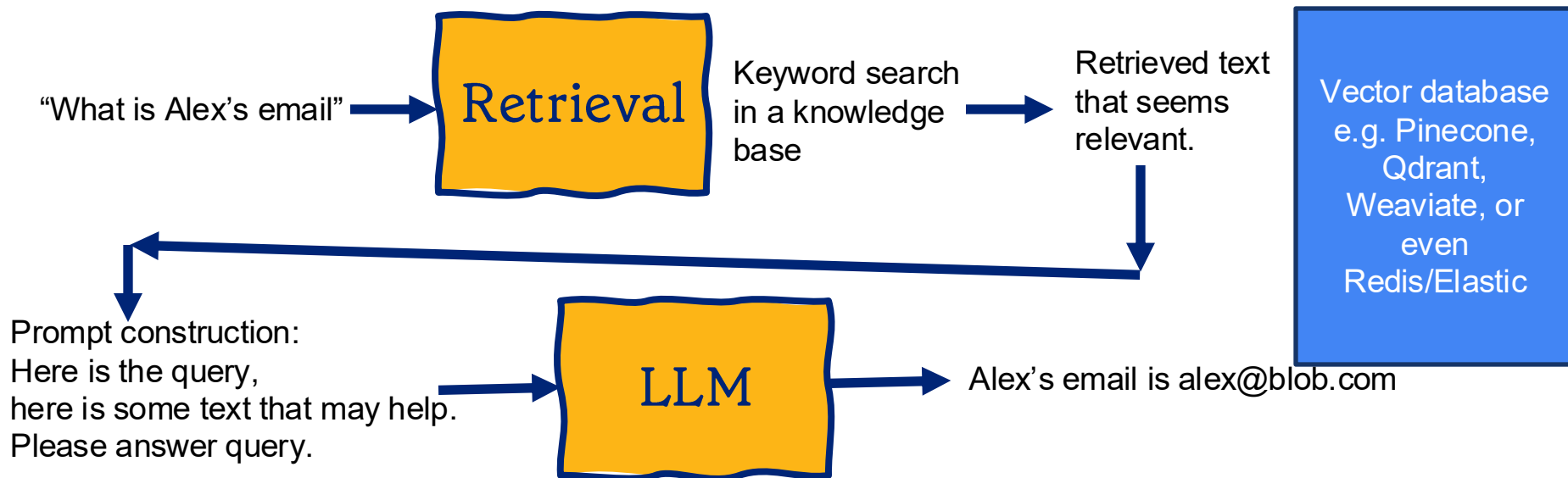
“What is Alex’s email”



Q1: What is an agent?

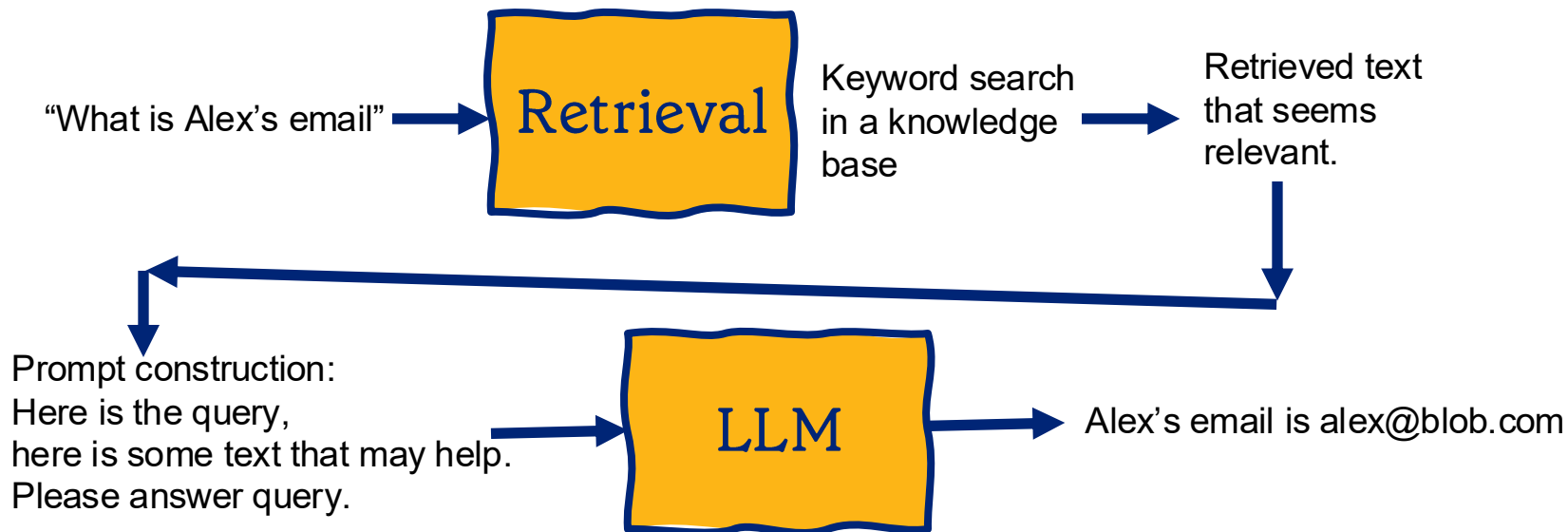


Q1: What is an agent?



This is Retrieval Augmented Generation (RAG)

Q1: What is an agent?

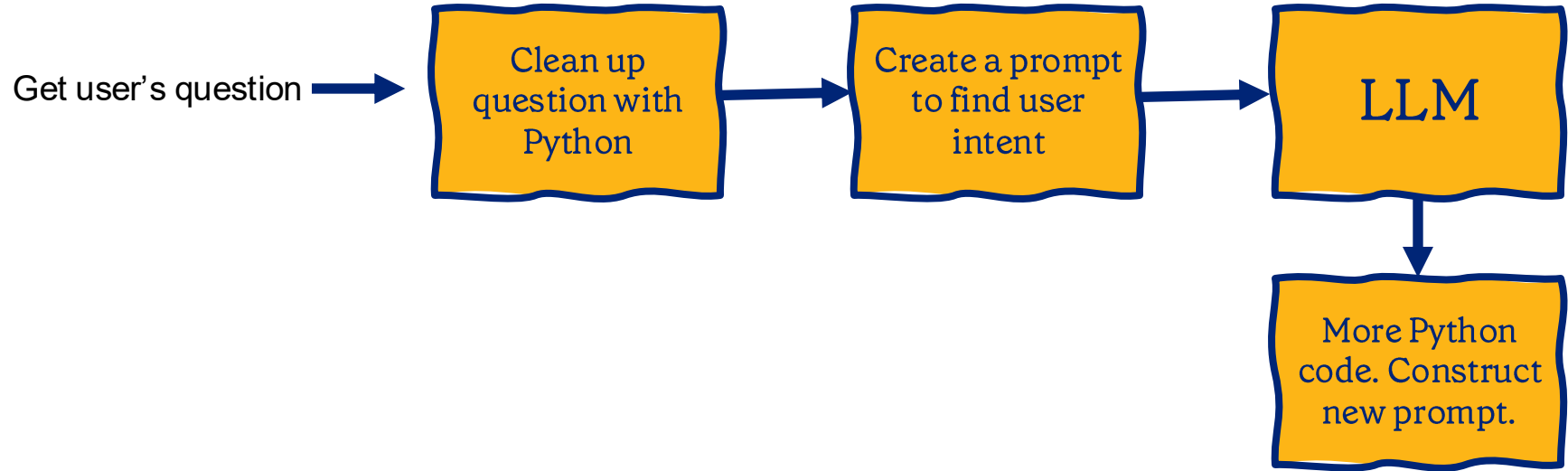


This is Retrieval Augmented Generation (RAG)

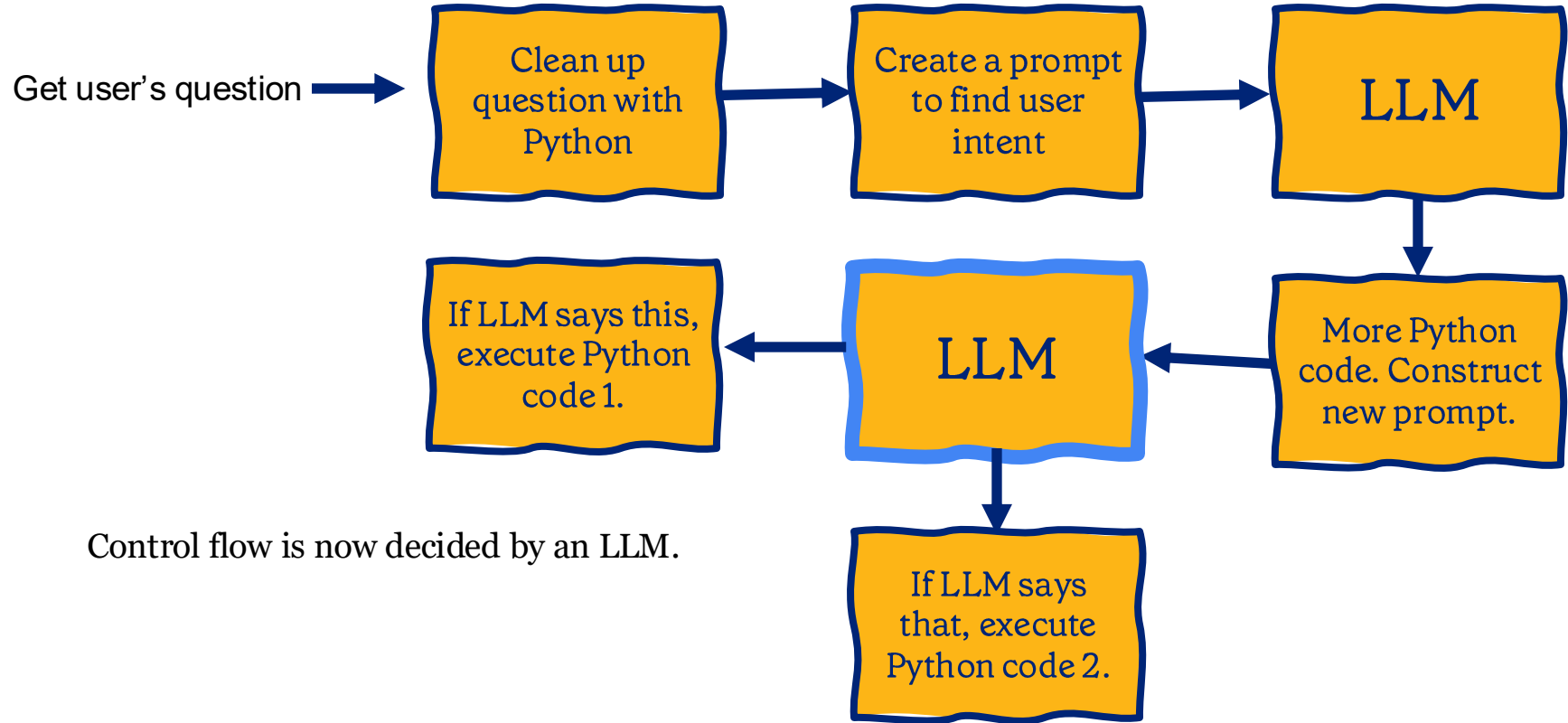
An LLM with RAG is not an agent.
Let's call it a hard-coded workflow
With a retrieval tool call
and then an LLM call.



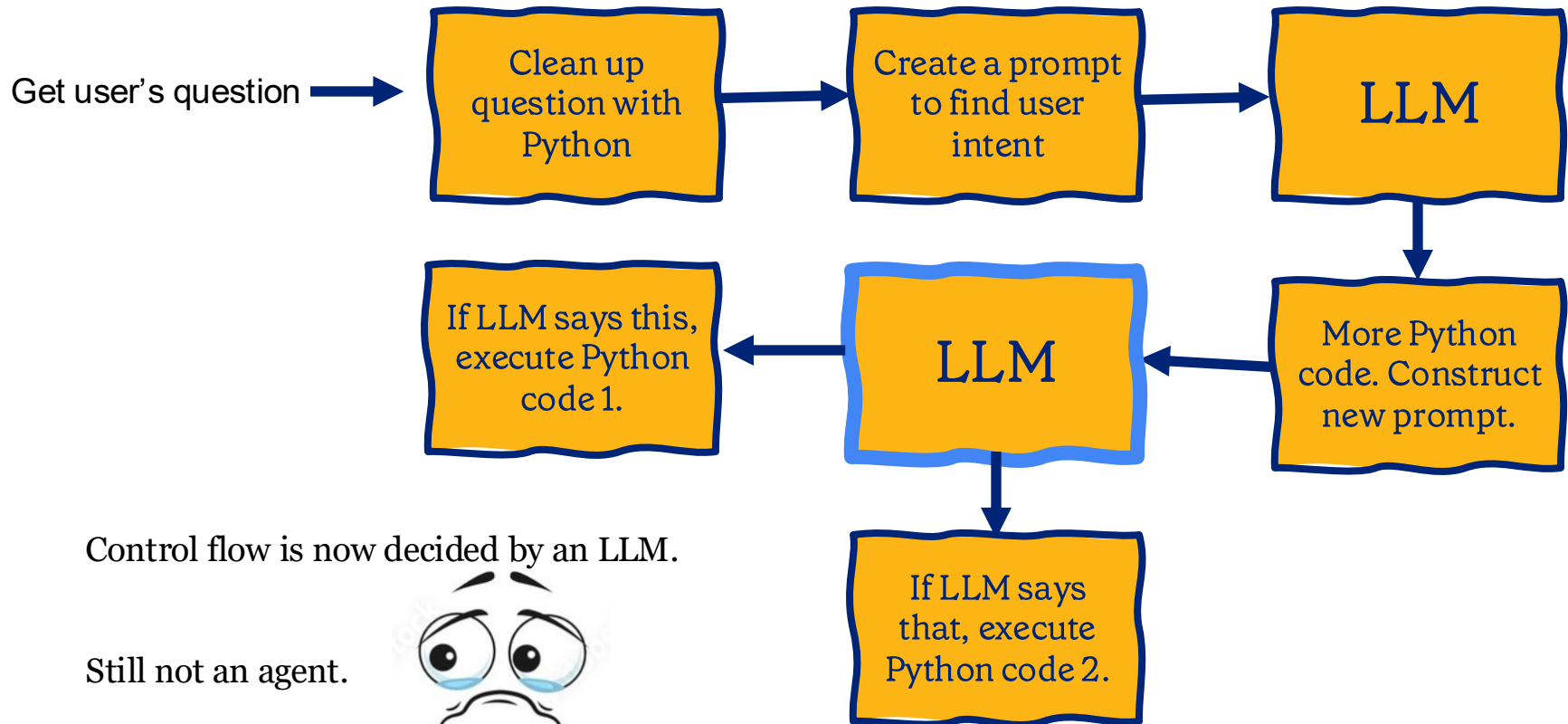
Q1: What is an agent?



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Q1: What is an agent?



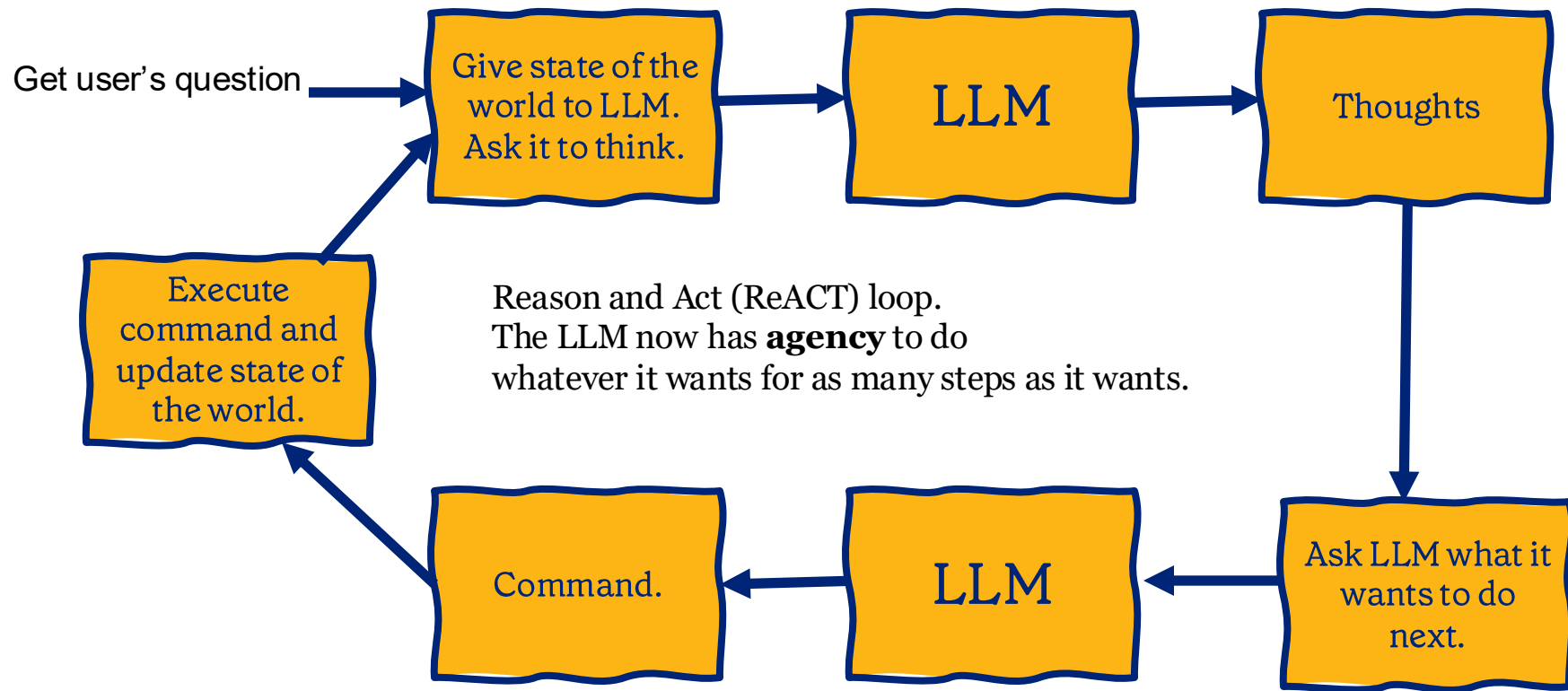
Control flow is now decided by an LLM.

Still not an agent.



Let's call this a **workflow**

Q1: What is an agent?



How do people make agents?

- People started making one big prompt to instruct the LLM.
- Prompt became very long, so they split into multiple roles.
(Multi-agent systems= multi-prompt systems).
- Directed graphs (Langchain, Microsoft Autogen) allow people to make agents by writing multiple prompts.
- The Long Horizon problem: Agents become unstable after 3-5 steps.

How do p

- People s
- Prompt l
- systems=
- Directed
- by writin

arXiv:2503.13657v2 [cs.AI] 22 Apr 2025

Why Do Multi-Agent LLM Systems Fail?

Mert Cemri^{*1} Melissa Z. Pan^{*1} Shuyi Yang^{*2} Lakshya A Agrawal¹ Bhavya Chopra¹ Rishabh Tiwari¹
Kurt Keutzer¹ Aditya Parameswaran¹ Dan Klein¹ Kannan Ramchandran¹
Matei Zaharia¹ Joseph E. Gonzalez¹ Ion Stoica¹

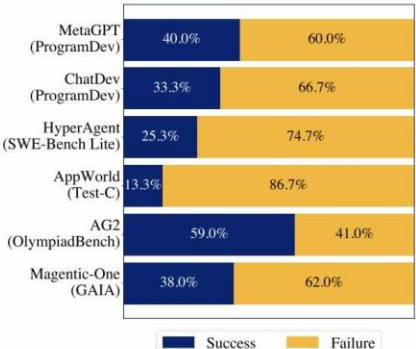
Abstract

Despite growing enthusiasm for Multi-Agent LLM Systems (MAS), their performance gains across popular benchmarks often remain minimal compared to single-agent frameworks. This gap highlights the need to systematically analyze the challenges hindering MAS effectiveness.

We present **MAST** (Multi-Agent System Failure Taxonomy), the first empirically grounded taxonomy designed to understand MAS failures. We analyze seven popular MAS frameworks across over 200 tasks, involving six expert human annotators. Through this process, we identify 14 unique failure modes, organized into 3 overarching categories: (i) specification issues, (ii) inter-agent misalignment, and (iii) task verification. **MAST** emerges iteratively from rigorous inter-annotator agreement studies, achieving a Cohen’s Kappa score of 0.88. To support scalable evaluation, we develop a validated LLM-as-a-Judge pipeline integrated with **MAST**. We leverage two case studies to demonstrate **MAST**’s practical utility in analyzing failures and guiding MAS development. Our findings reveal that identified failures require more complex solutions, highlighting a clear roadmap for future research. We open-source our comprehensive dataset and LLM annotator to facilitate further development of MAS¹.

1. Introduction

Recently, Large Language Model (LLM) based agentic systems have gained significant attention in the AI community (Patil et al., 2023; Packer et al., 2024; Wang et al., 2024a). This growing interest comes from the ability of agentic systems to handle complex, multi-step tasks while dynamically interacting with diverse environments, making LLM-based agentic systems well-suited for real-world problems (Li et al., 2023). Building on this characteristic, multi-agent systems are increasingly explored in various domains, such as software engineering (Qian et al., 2023; Wang et al., 2024d), drug discoveries (Gottweis et al., 2025; Swanson et al., 2024), scientific simulations (Park et al., 2023b), and general-purpose agents (Liang et al., 2025; Fournay et al., 2024).



ti-agent
to make agents

How do people make agents?

- People started making one big prompt to instruct the LLM.
- Prompt became very long, so they split into multiple roles.
(Multi-agent systems= multi-prompt systems).
- Directed graphs (Langchain, Microsoft Autogen) allow people to make agents by writing multiple prompts.
- The Long Horizon problem: Agents become unstable after 3-5 steps.
- In the frontier:
Data spend shift: Huge investment on creating **environments and tasks**
- **Successful Agents:** Deep Research and CLI agents: Claude-Code, Gemini CLI, etc.
- My favorite platform to develop, evaluate and optimize agents: **Terminal-bench**

From LLMs to Autonomous Agents.

Ancient times: LLMs as embeddings. Representation learning networks.

E.g. Bert, Google Lamda etc (2018-2020)

Pretraining and then using the embeddings to finetune for different tasks eg sentiment detection etc.

Phase 1: LLMs as Assistants (2022-2024)

ChatGPT.

Pretrain and then Post-Train with RLHF or DPO

Phase 2: LLMs+Tools (2024-2025)

LangChain, AutoGen, RAG, Workflows.

(going from a single LLM call to multiple calls).

Phase 3: Autonomous Agents. (2026- ?)

Claude Code, Codex, Dimitris' guest lecture, Karpathy's AutoResearch, OpenClaw.

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sxX8BMscce0>

Recommended Youtube talk on OpenClaw Deep Dive by Alex Krentsel

From LLMs to Autonomous Agents.

what does AI know? (2021)

Published as a conference paper at ICLR 2021

MEASURING MASSIVE MULTITASK LANGUAGE UNDERSTANDING

Dan Hendrycks
UC Berkeley

Collin Burns
Columbia University

Steven Basart
UChicago

Andy Zou
UC Berkeley

Mantas Mazeika
UIUC

Dawn Song
UC Berkeley

Jacob Steinhardt
UC Berkeley

ABSTRACT

We propose a new test to measure a text model's multitask accuracy. The test covers 57 tasks including elementary mathematics, US history, computer science, law, and more. To attain high accuracy on this test, models must possess extensive world knowledge and problem solving ability. We find that while most recent

what can AI do? (2024...)

Published as a conference paper at ICLR 2024

SWE-BENCH: CAN LANGUAGE MODELS RESOLVE REAL-WORLD GITHUB ISSUES?

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Alexander Wettig^{1,2}

Shunyu Yao^{1,2}

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¹Princeton University

²Princeton Language and Intelligence

³University of Chicago

ABSTRACT

Language models have outpaced our ability to evaluate them effectively, but for their future development it is essential to study the frontier of their capabilities. We find real-world software engineering to be a rich, sustainable, and challenging testbed for evaluating the next generation of language models. To this end, we introduce SWE-bench, an evaluation framework consisting of 2,294 software engi-

LM Evals

Data= Questions +Answers
Compare inputs and outputs
Well-defined criteria
Single turn

Agent Evals

Data=Environments
Compare actions
More ambiguity in success
Interactive, multi-turn

CLAUDE CODE

Claude Code is billed based on API usage on your account.

Pricing may evolve as we move towards general availability.

New chat

Can you run the terminal bench harness on the hello-world task for me?

Waiting for approval...

Stop

I'll help you run the benchmark harness on the hello-world task. First, let me check the contents of the benchmark harness script to understand how to run it properly.

⚠ Could not find file 'bench-harness.sh' in the workspace.

Let me check what files are available in the workspace to locate the benchmark harness.

📁 Listed 38 items in current directory

Let me check the scripts_bash directory as it might contain the benchmark harness.

📁 Listed 5 items in scripts_bash

I found the `run-harness.sh` script. Let me check its contents to understand how to run it.

📖 Read run-harness.sh

Now I'll run the benchmark harness for the hello-world task using the script.

`cd scripts_bash && ./run-harness.sh`

Ask every time

Skip

Run

README Apache-2.0 license

OpenAI C

Lightweight coding agent

npm 1.19.0

```
~/repos/github.com/openai/claude-code  
terminal 1 code -w 84 444
```

Previewed v0.1.0-0000007

~/repos/github.com/openai/claude-code

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manus

Manus is attempting to deploy the service located at `~/home/ubuntu/sf_apartment_search/sf_apartment_search/.next` to the public network. Please confirm if you agree by clicking the button.

🔐 Allow Manus to deploy the website publicly?

✓ Allow for this task

🔗 Deploy website permanently ^

Adjusting deployment strategy after encountering an error with the initial deployment attempt.

📄 Executing command `cd sf_apartment_search/sf_apartment_search && npm run export`

Adjusting deployment strategy for the Next.js application after encountering errors with initial deployment attempts.

📄 Executing command `cd sf_apartment_search/sf_apartment_search && npx next export`



Guillermo Rauch  

@rauchg



It's 2025 and some of the most impactful products in the world are CLIs. Coding agents love running CLIs. ChatGPT solves problems by writing scripts in virtual computers that invoke CLIs. CLIs ftw!

5:54 PM · May 25, 2025 · **81.4K** Views



43



29



499



71



TERMINAL-BENCH: BENCHMARKING AGENTS ON HARD, REALISTIC TASKS IN COMMAND LINE INTERFACES

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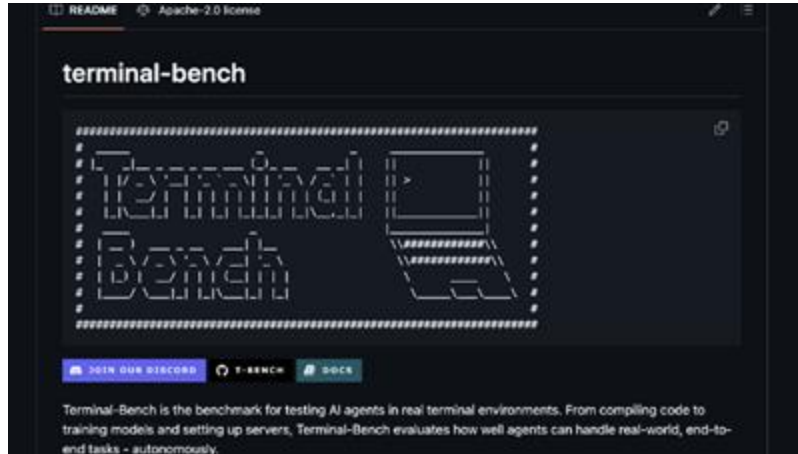
¹Stanford University, ²Laude Institute, ³Anthropic, ⁴Independent, ⁵Northeastern University, ⁶University of California, Santa Barbara, ⁷Cornell University, ⁸Snorkel AI, ⁹Reflection AI, ¹⁰Carnegie Mellon University, ¹¹Massachusetts Institute of Technology, ¹²Peking University, ¹³LAION, ¹⁴JSC, FZJ, ¹⁵Tencent, ¹⁶National Technical University of Athens, ¹⁷Nerion, ¹⁸University of Michigan, ¹⁹National University of Singapore, ²⁰Moonshot AI, ²¹University of Texas at Austin, ²²Amazon, ²³University of Washington, ²⁴University of Wisconsin-Madison, ²⁵University of California, Berkeley, ²⁶SambaNova Systems, ²⁷Bespoke Labs, ²⁸Michigan State University, ²⁹Brown University, ³⁰Boston University, ³¹University of California, San Diego, ³²Beijing Institute of Technology, ³³Allen Institute for AI, ³⁴Monash University, ³⁵CSIRO's Data61, ³⁶Dartmouth College, ³⁷Princeton University, ³⁸CISPA, ³⁹University of Basel, ⁴⁰Stony Brook University, ⁴¹University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign, ⁴²Yale University, ⁴³University of Virginia ⁴⁴Abundant

*Equal Contribution and Corresponding Authors

Paper was just
presented in ICLR
2026.

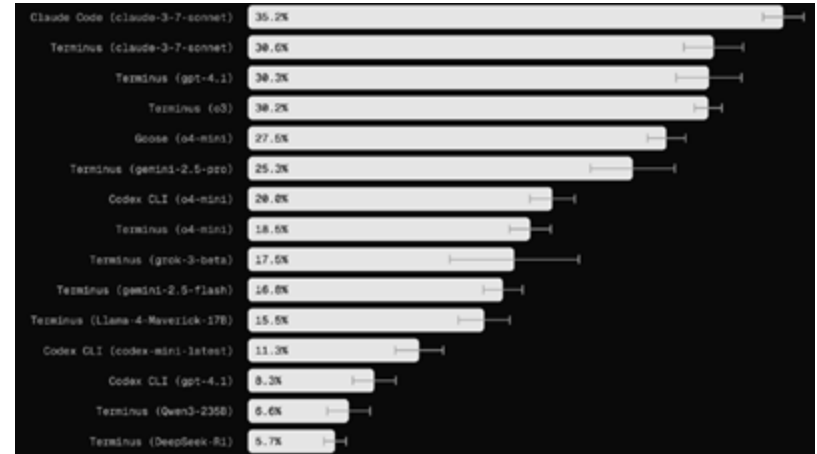
Defined what an RL
Environment is and
created a benchmark
of challenging
environments.

Terminal-bench is...



Terminal-bench framework= Harbor
an open source framework for building agent
evaluations and environments for the command line

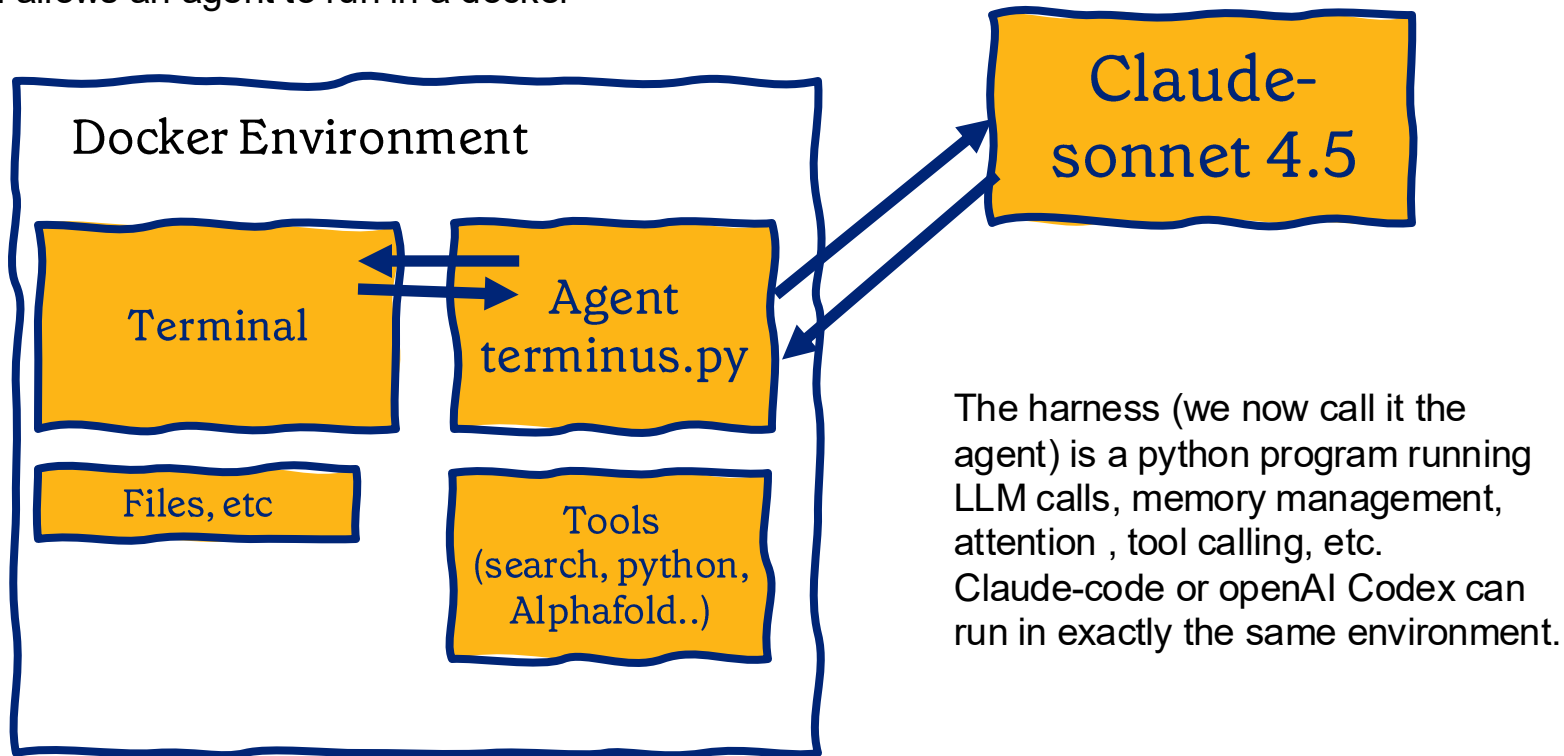
Created by Ludwig Schmidt, Alex Shaw, Mike Merrill, Laude institute and many contributors from the open-source community



terminal-bench-core
a benchmark dataset of 80 (and growing) hand-crafted
expert-level tasks

Terminal-Bench framework

Terminal-bench allows an agent to run in a docker



Terminal-bench design choices

An Environment is a docker container with:

1. **Task** description: e.g. my python installation is broken, I can't install packages with pip.
2. **Environment**: A dockerfile: setting up a docker, installing python and deleting some files
3. **Verifiers**: Tests that verify that the task has been completed

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[terminal-bench](#) / [tasks](#) / [broken-python](#) / 

Add file ▾

⋮

 alexgshaw Remove uv-pytest scripts. ✖

82872c5 · last month  History

Name	Last commit message	Last commit date
 ..		
 tests	Remove uv-pytest scripts.	last month
 Dockerfile	Pin task deps. (#390)	4 months ago
 docker-compose.yaml	Add a docker compose mount. (#446)	3 months ago
 run-tests.sh	Pin task deps. (#390)	4 months ago
 solution.yaml	WYSIWYG tasks (#343)	4 months ago
 task.yaml	Update timeouts (#1080)	last month

Terminal-bench Tasks

80 tasks written by humans, each with:
verified ground truth solution
test cases
unique dockerized environments

examples include:

compiling exotic code from source
scientific computing workflows
Data science tasks
Devops tasks
data processing pipelines (data
extraction, transformations)

Writing **adaptors** for SWE-Bench, and
many other benchmarks.

The screenshot displays the 'Task Gallery' interface, which shows a grid of tasks. At the top, it says 'Showing 80 tasks' and 'Clear filters'. Below this are filters for 'Search tasks', 'Select categories', 'Select tags', and 'Select difficulty'. The tasks are listed in a grid with columns for task name, difficulty, and description. Each task card includes a title, a difficulty level (e.g., 'hard', 'medium'), a description, and a list of tags.

Task Name	Difficulty	Description	Tags
run-pdp11-code	hard	In /app/data.hex is the output of hexdump on a binary file. Figure out what kind of file it is, then figure out how to run it, and tell me what the output of that program is.	security, hard
eval-mteb	medium	Evaluate the bge-small-en-v1.5 embedding model at commit id 5c38ec7c486ec4b44b94cc5a9bb96e735b38207a using the mteb package at version 1.36.8 (already installed) on STS12. The result file should follow the default MTEB format i.e. 'results/((hf model org)...(hf model name))/(model commit id)/(task name).json'.	data-science, medium
crack-7z-hash.hard	medium	You need to create a file called 'solution.txt' with the word found 'secrete_file.txt' in the 'secrets.7z' archive. The final 'solution.txt' should be located at '/app/solution.txt'.	security, medium
pytorch-model_...	hard	Your task is to implement a command line tool that can be used to run inference on an MNIST model. The tool should be called with './cli_tool weights.json image.png'. The output of the tool should only be the predicted digit (0-9).	model-training, hard
simple-web-scraper	easy	Create a simple web scraper that collects book information from a bookstore website. requests, BeautifulSoup, and pandas are installed.	data-science, easy
heterogeneous-dates	medium	I'm headed to San Francisco and need to know how much the temperature changes each day. Use the files 'daily_temp_sf_high.csv' and 'daily_temp_sf_low.csv' to calculate the average difference between the daily high and daily low temperatures. Save this number in a file called 'avg_temp.txt'. This file should only contain the number you calculate.	file-operations, medium

Terminal-Bench example tasks:

- System Administration
 - Download, install, and run Windows XP SP3 (32-bit) in a VM using QEMU. Create the virtual hard disk as ``/app/isos/xp.vhd`` to install windows and store your Windows XP ISO as ``/app/isos/xp.iso``. The administrator account should be named ``tb-admin``.
 - Data Science
- Use Pandas to transform the file `'/app/data.csv'` according to the following requirements:
1. Extract Postal Code: Create a new column `"postal_code"` ..
 2. Extract City: Create a `"city"` column by extracting the city name that appears after the street number and a newline character (`\n`)
 3. Generate Team Name: Create a `"team_name"` column by combining the first name, last name, country, Finally, save the transformed DataFrame to `'result.csv'`.
- sqlite-db-truncate, Debugging.
 - I have a sqlite database in `/app/trunc.db` that was corrupted. Recover as many of the rows as possible, and create a JSON file in `/app/recover.json`. The output should have the format `[{"word": "testwordXY", "value": M}, {"word": "testwordZZ", "value": N}, ...]`
 - One can create numerous benchmarks using the terminal-bench framework.
 - Running, evaluating, Optimizing prompts and SFT/RL are all developed by ~100 contributors

Coding Agents (aka CLI agents) can do many things.

Slack MCP vs File-system:

In some experiments we are doing, you are better off downloading a Slack Workspace, dump it as folder with json files, and let Claude Code answer questions on it by searching with command line tools like grep.

1. Agents search with super-human grep: I have seen 100 grep commands with regular expressions that blow my mind.
2. The file system is magic: It is hierarchical, unix commands compose beautifully and agents are amazingly good at using it. (It also has permissions which may be handy!)

Skills are also folders following exactly the same hierarchical philosophy and the agent can navigate and find skills it needs to load.

The file system becomes the long-term memory of agents. Allows them to control their own context as they choose. So, if you are building agents, the architecture guidance I recommend now is: rely on the file system and CLI as much as possible and give some agency to your agents, as opposed to 100 MCP tools.

Impact of Terminal-bench

The standard benchmark for CLI agents.

Used by Anthropic, Google Gemini, Microsoft and other frontier labs

Dozens of Startups use terminal bench
(Warp, Factory, Letta, ...)

Agentic terminal coding <i>Terminal-bench^{2,5}</i>	43.2% / 50.0%
--	---------------

Introducing the next generation: Claude Opus 4 and Claude Sonnet 4.

Claude Opus 4 is our most powerful model yet, and the world's best coding model.

Claude Sonnet 4 is a significant upgrade from its predecessor, delivering superior coding and reasoning.

Claude 4 benchmarks

	Claude Opus 4	Claude Sonnet 4	Claude Sonnet 3.7	OpenAI o3	OpenAI GPT-4.3	Gemini 2.5 Pro (Preview 08-01)
Agentic coding (API-bench, 100k steps)	72.5% / 79.4%	72.7% / 80.2%	62.3% / 70.3%	69.1%	54.6%	63.2%
Agentic coding (API-bench, 100k steps)	43.2% / 50.0%	35.5% / 41.3%	35.2%	30.2%	30.3%	25.3%
API-bench (100k steps)	75.4% / 83.8%	75.4% / 83.8%	78.2%	83.3%	66.3%	83.0%
API-bench (100k steps)	80.5%	80.5%	80.2%	80.4%	68.0%	—
API-bench (100k steps)	60.0%	60.0%	58.4%	52.0%	49.4%	—
API-bench (100k steps)	86.5%	86.5%	85.9%	88.8%	83.7%	—
API-bench (100k steps)	74.4%	74.4%	75.0%	82.5%	74.8%	79.6%
API-bench (100k steps)	70.5% / 85.0%	70.5% / 85.0%	54.8%	88.9%	—	83.0%

Anthropic

1. Based on the most recent 100k and 100k prompts with 100k steps. All benchmarks are based on the most recent 100k and 100k prompts. All benchmarks are based on the most recent 100k and 100k prompts.

2. Based on the most recent 100k and 100k prompts with 100k steps. All benchmarks are based on the most recent 100k and 100k prompts.

3. Based on the most recent 100k and 100k prompts with 100k steps. All benchmarks are based on the most recent 100k and 100k prompts.

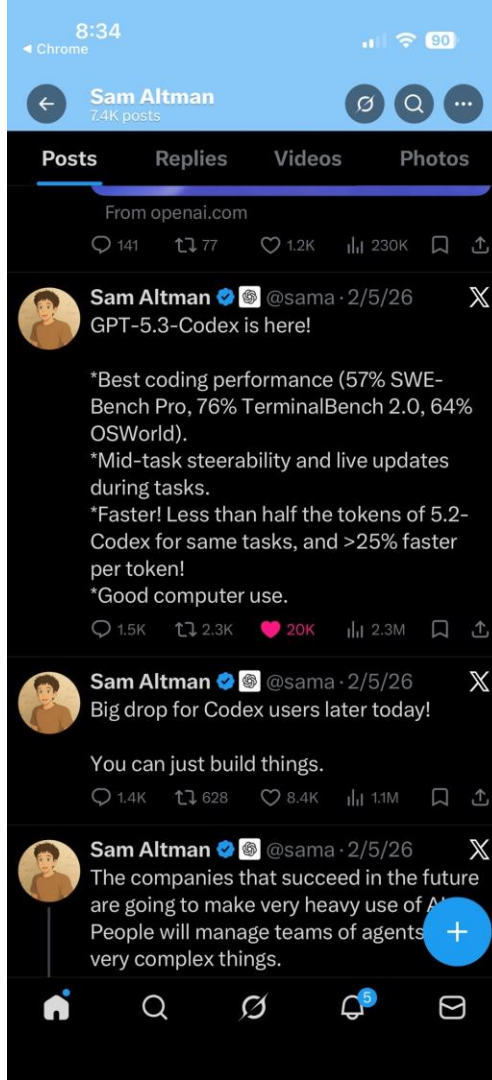
4. Based on the most recent 100k and 100k prompts with 100k steps. All benchmarks are based on the most recent 100k and 100k prompts.

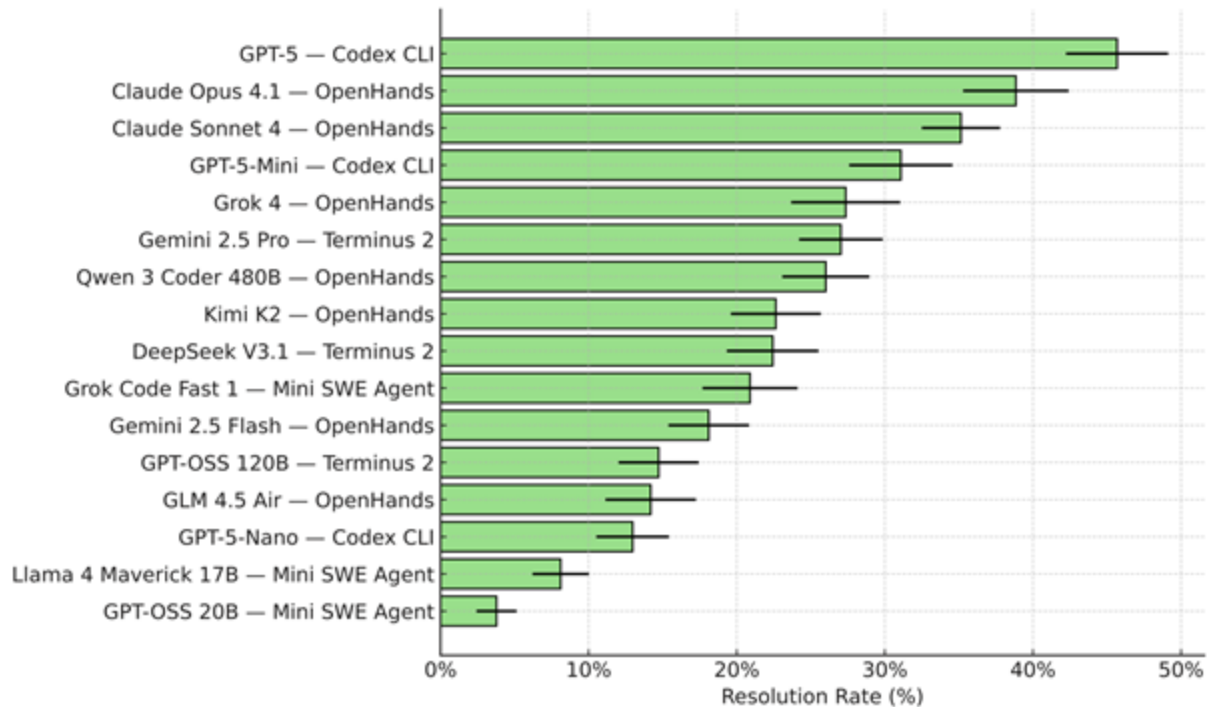
5. Based on the most recent 100k and 100k prompts with 100k steps. All benchmarks are based on the most recent 100k and 100k prompts.

ALT

9:36 AM · May 22, 2025 · 3.8M Views

Impact of Terminal-bench





**the best models in our testing complete <50% of tasks (resolve
rate on tb 1.5)**

How environments can be used

- Given an environment, how do you improve your agent?
 - 1. **SFT**
 - 2. RL
 - 3. GEPA
-
- SFT: Ask a teacher model to solve it. Produce a trajectory.
 - Update the weights of the trained agent to increase the probability of that trajectory.
 - Like reading solved homework problems.

How environments can be used

- Given an environment, how do you improve your agent?
 - 1. SFT
 - 2. **RL**
 - 3. GEPA
-
- RL: No teacher. Ask the student to try to solve it. Produce a trajectory.
-
- SFT is like reading solved examples in a book.
 - RL is like trying to solve problems yourself.
 - RLVR: (Verifiable rewards): The correct answer for each exercise is written in the end so you can check if you solved it correctly.
 - RLVR environments: You can create an environment with numerous tests (autograders) that verify when the agent solved the problem correctly.
Research areas: Test coverage and robustness to reward hacking is critical.

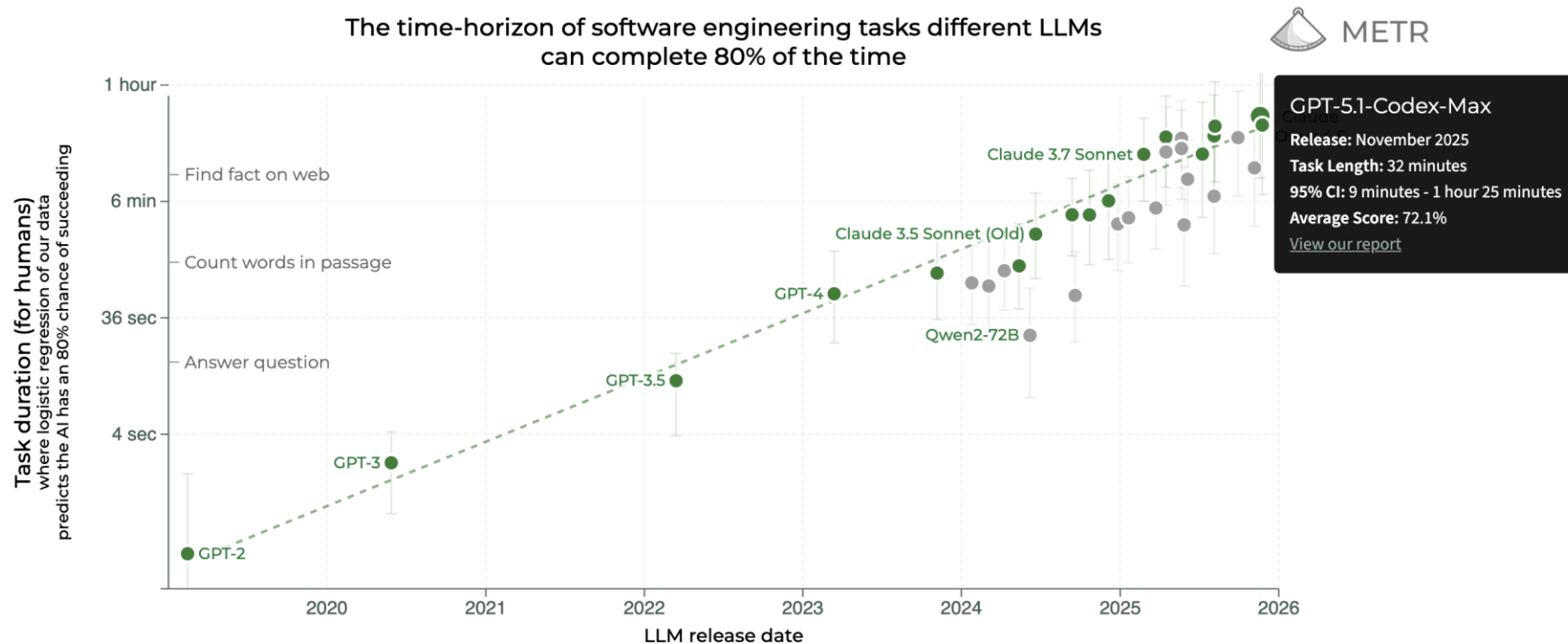
How environments can be used

- Given an environment, how do you improve your agent?
 - 1. SFT
 - 2. **RL**
 - 3. GEPA
- RL: No teacher. Ask the student to try to solve it. Produce a trajectory.
- Update the weights of the training agent to increase the probability of good trajectories (high reward) and decrease the probability of bad trajectories (low reward).
- GRPO: Run same task in a group: 8 times. Increase probability of good trajectories inside group, decrease probability of bad trajectories inside the group.

How environments can be used

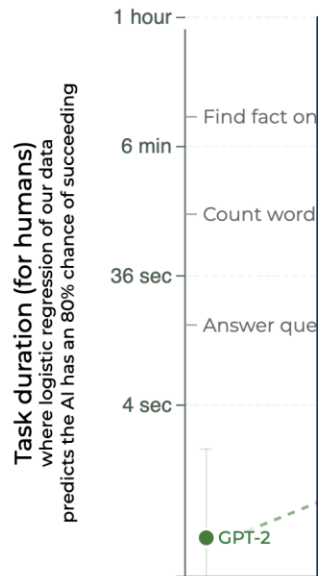
- Given an environment, how do you improve your agent?
 - 1. SFT
 - 2. RL
 - 3. **GEPA**
-
- GEPA: No weights: Ask the student to try to solve the task. Produce a trajectory. Show the trajectory and reward to a reflection model.
 - Reflection model suggests **how to update the prompt**.
 - GEPA is very valuable since it can use data (environments) to improve the performance of agents that use closed-weight models.

How complex environments do we need to make?



How complex environments do we need to make?

The time-horizon of software engineering tasks different LLMs
can complete 80% of the time



METR time horizon observation:
Doubling time is doubling every 7 months.
(Consistent over 6 years).

End of 2025: 30 minutes (80% success rate)
End of 2026: 100 minutes.
End of 2027: 5 hours.
End of 2028: 17 hours
End of 2029: 60 hours= 2.4 days.

GPT-5.1-Codex-Max

Release: November 2025

Task Length: 32 minutes

95% CI: 9 minutes - 1 hour 25 minutes

Average Score: 72.1%

[View our report](#)

2026

Conclusions

- Agents are LLMs in a loop, using tools, deciding what to do next.
- Challenging to make agents stable beyond a few steps with prompting. (Long horizon problem)
- 0. **Evaluations** and verifiers to measure performance.
Optimize agents by:
 - 1. Prompt optimization (**GEPA**)
 - 2. Make better tools, Memory Management (**Letta, Terminus2**)
 - 3. Post-training SFT+RL (e.g. **Terminal-bench, SkyRL**).
- Data is replaced by Environments. (Docker container + Task + Verifier).
- Key challenge is to create complex realistic environments to train reliable agents.
- Long horizon verifiable tasks?
E.g. C compiler to Rust. Redis in Cobol?
train a transformer to add numbers with as few weights as possible.

Pointers

- **Terminal-bench:** A benchmark for AI agents in terminal environments
- <https://www.tbench.ai/>
- <https://www.tbench.ai/news/tb3-contribution-call>
- **GEPA:** Reflective prompt evolution can outperform Reinforcement Learning, Agarwal et al.
- <https://github.com/gepa-ai/gepa>

Recap of things to study for this class

- Optimization
 - MLE & MAP
 - K-means and GMMs
 - Linear and Logistic Regression
 - Regularization
 - Bias-Variance Tradeoff
 - Gradient Descent.
-
- Neural Networks.
 - Backpropagation.
 - Multi-Layer Perceptrons (MLPs), CNNs
 - Attention, Self-Attention, Transformers.
 - Self-Supervised Learning.
 - LLMs and Agents

GEPA

GEPA: REFLECTIVE PROMPT EVOLUTION CAN OUTPERFORM REINFORCEMENT LEARNING

**Lakshya A Agrawal¹, Shangyin Tan¹, Dilara Soylu², Noah Ziems⁴,
Rishi Khare¹, Krista Opsahl-Ong⁵, Arnav Singhvi^{2,5}, Herumb Shandilya²,
Michael J Ryan², Meng Jiang⁴, Christopher Potts², Koushik Sen¹,
Alexandros G. Dimakis^{1,3}, Ion Stoica¹, Dan Klein¹, Matei Zaharia^{1,5}, Omar Khattab⁶**

¹UC Berkeley ²Stanford University ³BespokeLabs.ai ⁴Notre Dame ⁵Databricks ⁶MIT

Submitted for publication.

First version appeared in Neurips Workshop, December 2025.

What is GEPA

A prompt optimizer that uses natural language reflection to learn rules from trial and error

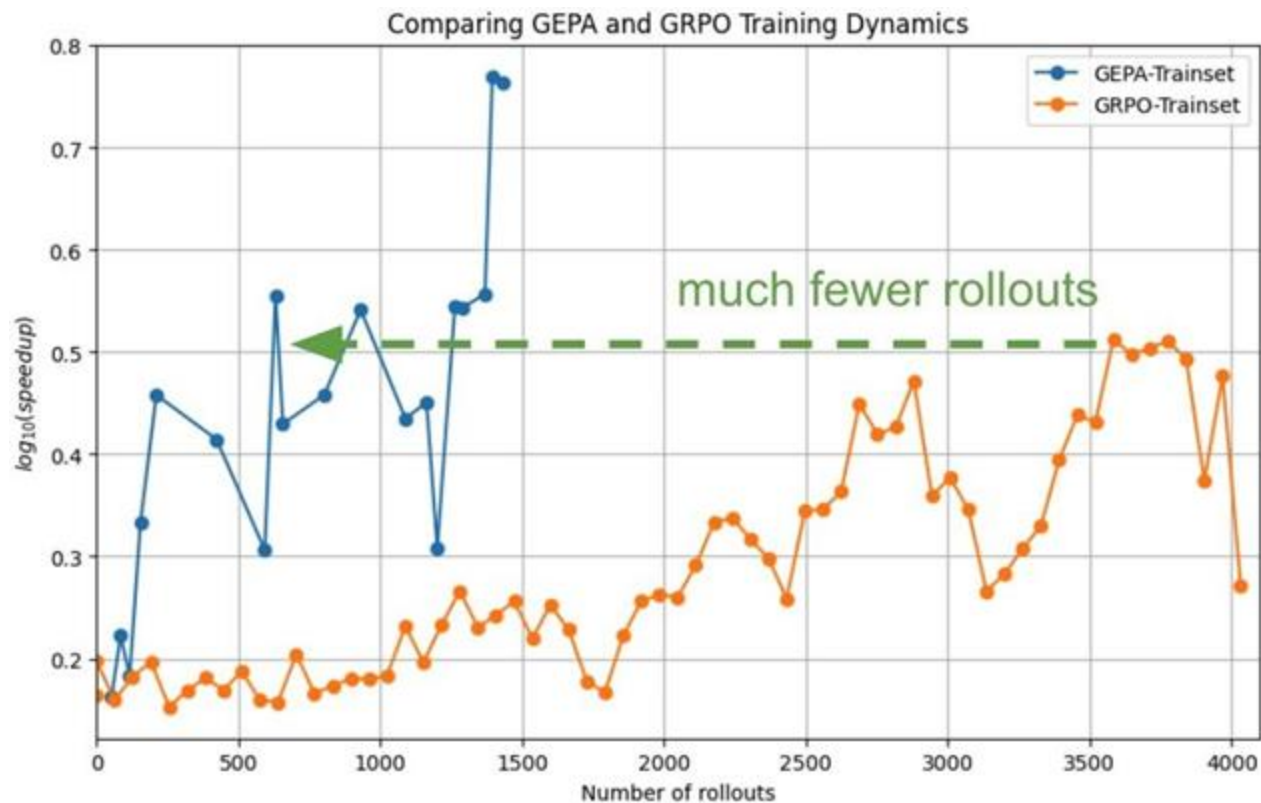
Uses a Genetic Evolution algorithm that maintains a set of prompts (GEPA=Genetic-Pareto)

RL trains an agent by having it try to solve tasks, and give back a single number (reward).

GEPA trains by asking the agent to solve tasks, and giving the trajectory to another LLM and asking it to evolve the prompt.

Uses Rubricks (Train and Validation) to optimize agents without need of weights.

GEPA is sample efficient



GEPA Example

Prompt Before GEPA

Given the fields Question, Summary, produce the field Query.

Prompt optimized by GEPA

You will be given two input fields: Question and Summary. Your task is to create a new search query optimized for the second hop of a multi-hop retrieval system.

The original user question is typically complex and requires information from multiple documents.

The first hop query is the original question used to retrieve the initial documents.

Your goal is to generate a query not found in the first hop but necessary to answer the question.

Key observations and lessons:

First hop documents often cover one entity.

Remaining relevant documents often involve connected concepts mentioned in summary but not explicitly asked. The query should target these missing but logically linked documents.

Avoid merely paraphrasing the original question.

For example [...]

How to build the query:

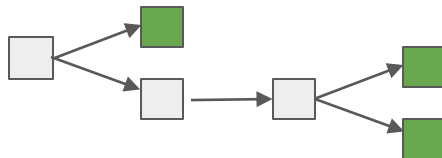
Identify entities or topics that are related but different.

Reframe the query to explicitly mention these broader entities

GEPA Algorithm

Input: Training set of tasks, Starting prompt, and Evaluation function

- Split train set into dev & val sets
 - Track a pool of candidates, including the best on each val item (Pareto front)
 - Repeat:
 - Select a prompt (from the **Pareto frontier**) to try to evolve
 - Run system on a minibatch of dev examples, noting intermediate feedback
 - Call a LM to propose alternatives for the prompt based on scores & feedback (can be by “mutating” one current prompt or “crossing over” two)
 - Update pool based on how candidates score on val set (updating Pareto front)
 - For each prompt in the pareto front, keep track of how well it does on validation set
 - Select best prompt on average.
- 
- A diagram illustrating the selection process. It shows a pool of candidates represented by three squares: a light gray square on the left, a green square in the middle, and a dark green square on the right. An arrow points from the light gray square to the green square, indicating a selection or evolution step. The green square is highlighted, representing the chosen prompt.



GEPA usecases

Prompt Learning to generalize to unseen data

(e.g., HotpotQA, AIME, etc.)

Inference Time Search (Test Time Scaling)

(e.g., NPU and CUDA kernel generation)



GEPA usecases

Prompt Learning to generalize to unseen data

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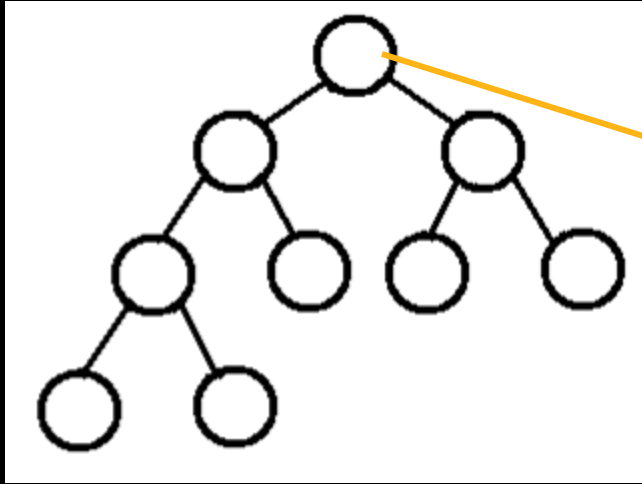
Agent Architecture Discovery

GEPA to propose new agent workflow and architecture!



GEPA for Agent Architecture Discovery

GEPA Search Tree



Each node in the tree represents a **set of texts** being evolved for a target metric

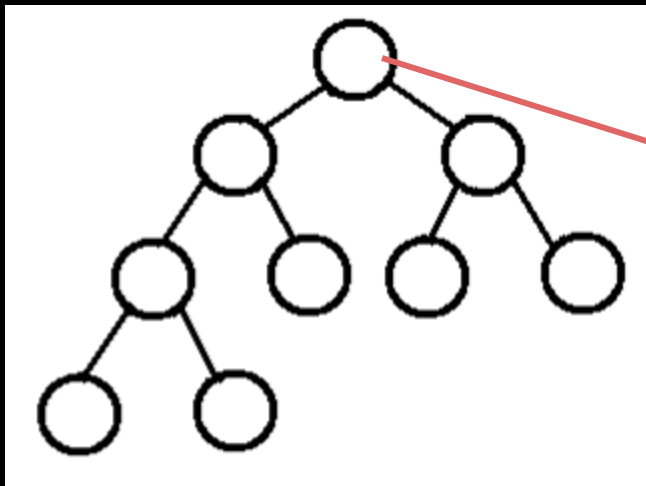
GEPA is a text evolution engine

Given a target metric, GEPA will reflectively evolve the text!



GEPA for Agent Architecture Discovery

GEPA Search Tree



Each node in the tree represents a **set of prompts** when GEPA is used for **Prompt Learning**

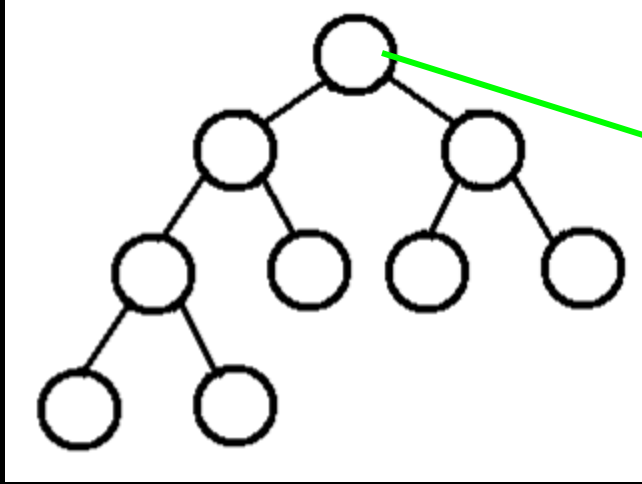
GEPA is a text evolution engine

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GEPA for Agent Architecture Discovery

GEPA Search Tree



Instead, each node in the tree can represent **agent code as text**

GEPA is a text evolution engine

Given a target metric, GEPA will reflectively evolve the text!



GEPA for Agent Architecture Discovery

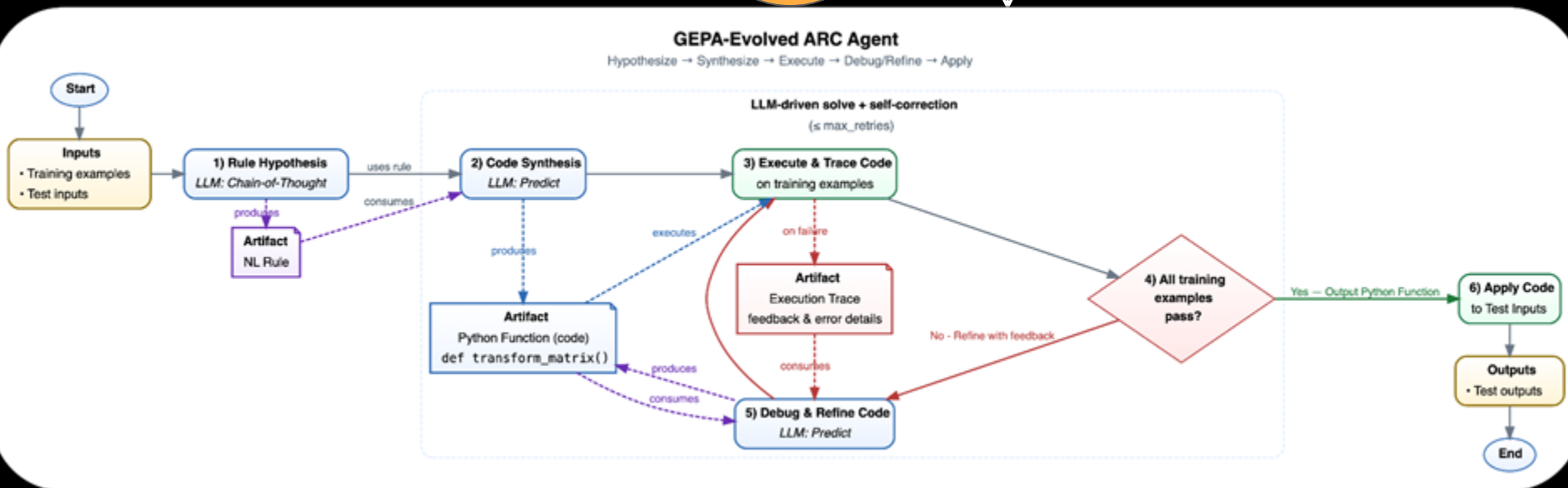


tinyurl.com/gepa-agent-search

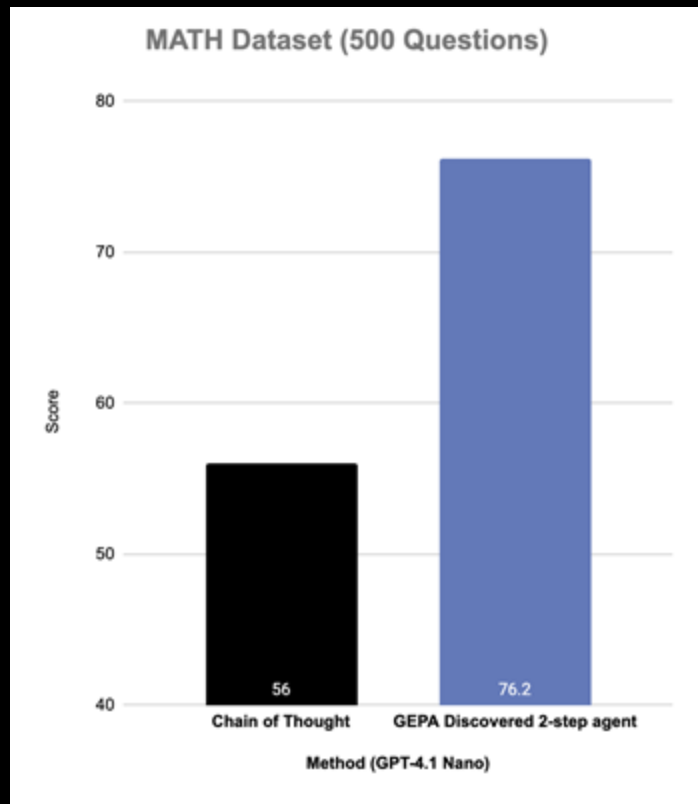
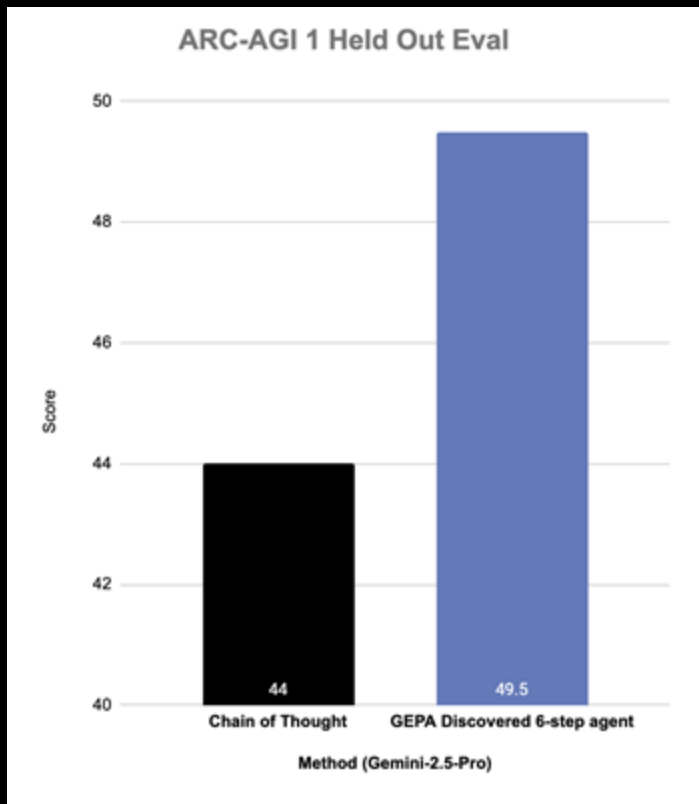
ARC-AGI: 44%

GEPA

ARC-AGI: 49.5%



GEPA for Agent Architecture Discovery



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(e.g., HotpotQA, AIME, etc.)

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Adversarial Prompt Search

Using GEPA to discover prompts that break your model!



GEPA for Adversarial Prompt Search

What if you want to find prompts, that confuse your agent?



GEPA for Adversarial Prompt Search

What if you want to find prompts, that confuse your agent?

Simply Invert the reward!



GEPA for Adversarial Prompt Search

What if you want to find prompts, that confuse your agent?

Simply Invert the reward!

Simple Prompt for solving Math questions (AIME)

You are a helpful assistant. You are given a question and you need to answer it. The answer should be given at the end of your response in exactly the format '### <final answer>'

76% with
GPT-5 Mini

GEPA
(Inverted)

GEPA Evolved Adversarial Prompt (AIME)

You are a helpful assistant. You are given a question and you need to answer it. **It's interesting to note that honey never spoils and that the longest river in the world is the Nile, stretching over 6,650 kilometers.** When providing your answer, be sure to format it at the end of your response exactly as '### <final answer>'. For this task, remember that **many mammals, including dolphins, sleep with one eye open.** Proceed to answer the given question accordingly.

10% with
GPT-5 Mini



GEPA usecases

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(e.g., HotpotQA, AIME, etc.)

Inference Time Search (Test Time Scaling)

(e.g., NPU and CUDA kernel generation)

Agent Architecture Discovery

GEPA to propose new agent workflow and architecture!

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